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Republican takes page out of Moulton playbook

Seeking District 6 seat, military vet Jones says he would be willing to cross the aisle

By Kelly Garrity
GLOBE STAFF

Hearing Micah Q. Jones explain why he wants to succeed Representative Seth Moulton in the Sixth Congressional District can, at times, sound a little familiar.

The Army veteran said he believes in “service more than anything.” Like Moulton a decade ago,

he’s a first-time candidate in his mid-30s who touts wanting to work across the aisle. And he lauded Moulton’s “heterodox way of thinking” and willingness to challenge his fellow Democrats.

“That’s an admirable thing, and something I would hope to emulate when needed,” Jones, 37, said.

There’s just one catch: Jones is

actually running in a different party. A half-dozen Democrats want to fill Moulton’s North Shore-anchored seat, but it is Jones, a onetime-Democrat-turned-Republican, who may strike the strongest comparison to the district’s six-term incumbent.

Jones is leaning into a profile that, in another political era, might have looked tailor-made for the North Shore district: military veteran, moderate, and openly skeptical of the ideological rigidity gripping both parties. He himself points to

Moulton — who first swept into office by doing the seemingly impossible: knocking off a Democratic incumbent — as a model.

No Republican has held a US House seat in Massachusetts in three decades. But Jones, a two-time Donald Trump voter, isn’t centering the culture-war issues that typically fire up grass-roots Republican voters. He’s promising to work with the Trump administration “when it makes sense, [and] push

JONES, Page A6

Harvard unions fear jobs being targeted

Say school’s political crises being used to justify cuts

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

Commencement is a wrap, and students are going home. But at Harvard University, temperatures are rising over an administrative restructuring plan that could result in sweeping staff layoffs this summer.

Leaders of the Faculty of Arts and Sciences, which proposed the plan, say they are trying to address a projected structural deficit of \$365 million, largely because of the looming endowment tax hike Congress imposed last year and capital expenses, including deferred building maintenance. That’s about 20 percent of annual spending for FAS, which houses the university’s undergraduate and PhD programs.

A task force tapped McKinsey & Company to consult on a cost-cutting model that has intensified tensions on campus. While the school has long had a structural deficit, financial uncertainties at the federal level are adding urgency to act, FAS dean Hopi Hoekstra wrote in an update in March 2025.

Union members and organizers aren’t buying it. They say that Harvard is doing fine financially — it has an endowment of \$56.9 billion — and that FAS managers are taking advantage of political crises to engineer cuts behind closed doors.

“It’s just a bargaining position, and they’re trying to squeeze the most work from the fewest peo-

HARVARD, Page A6



REBECCA BLACKWELL/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Haitian fans and players celebrated after forward Frantzdy Pierrot (20) scored at an international friendly match this week.

FOR HAITIANS, IT’S MUCH MORE THAN A GAME

At World Cup, player with Mass. roots will carry hopes of those who left turmoil behind

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

In a dimly lit basement bar in Boston’s Back Bay last week, the song was belted out in Haitian Creole: “Grenadye, alaso!”

The refrain loosely translates to “Grenadiers, charge,” and it’s a World Cup rallying cry for the Haitian national soccer team, Les Grenadiers. But its roots go much deeper than a stadium chant. It’s intertwined with the genesis of Haiti as a state. It was sung during the Haitian Revolution of the late 18th and early 19th century, a slavery revolt that birthed a nation, and the tune has heavy underpinnings of death, colonialism, and freedom. And the lyrics refer-



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Pierrot greeted high-school friend Robbie Pesaturo at the State House as they celebrated Frantzdy Pierrot Day last week.

ence the motherless and the fatherless.

“It means they, or we, as Africans were kidnapped and enslaved,” said Charlot Lucien, a Haitian artist who lives in Foxborough, and co-led the crowd in song. “We have nothing to lose.”

But in the speakeasy of Hue, it is sung with gusto, an outpouring of joy. The patrons were there to celebrate Haiti at the World Cup and toast a sporting hero who has roots in both Haiti and Massachusetts: a forward for the national team, Frantzdy Pierrot, 31, who went to high school at the northern end of the Orange Line.

The World Cup can have this ef-

HAITI, Page A7

Trahan takes heat from party over bill on AI regulation

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As Democratic Representative Lori Trahan worked to craft a bipartisan bill on artificial intelligence with a Republican colleague, the resistance was fierce and swift — from her own side of the aisle.

The Westford representative and her Republican counterpart on Thursday unveiled the proposal, which would impose safety requirements on developers of AI, the result of weeks of negotiations. But the release did little to mute criticism of the bill, and her involvement in it, illustrating the heightened politics of the issue.

Tech safety groups and some state political leaders have been trying to convince Trahan to abandon the talks, arguing it undermines efforts at the state level to regulate the rapidly advancing technology on issues such as child safety and civil rights. The spat has turned bitter and gone public in recent days, with a group that pushes AI regulation launching ads in Massachusetts

TRAHAN, Page A5



Steam players

Friday: Another hot one. High 84-89. Low 67-72.

Saturday: And another one. High 88-93. Low 64-69.

High tide: 3:02 a.m., 3:44 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:08 Sunset: 8:17

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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Employees at the Museum of African American History found Juneteenth decorations on fire in a secluded corner. **B1.**

Karen Read filed suit against the State Police and the Town of Canton for allegedly hiring “virulent bigots” she contends tried to frame her. **B1.**



A mahogany desk that once belonged to Paul Revere is headed to the auction block and is expected to fetch up to \$30,000 Friday. **B5.**

The Red Sox continued their losing ways at Fenway, falling to the Orioles, 8-2, after another bad start by Brayan Bello. **C1.**

Need for NeeDoh can no longer be satisfied

Squishy toy born in North Andover is soaring on TikTok high

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

Before we get to the scene of the eccentric toy company CEO gathering his staff in a conference room in North Andover nine years ago, holding up a squishy stress ball, and declaring “This is the future,” let’s start at the future, which is happening now.

Man walks into a toy store. Could be any toy store in America at the moment, but this one, Learning Express Toys and Gifts in Andover, happens to be the closest one to that conference room. Man asks if they have any NeeDoh. Staff exchange side-eyed glances. *We’ve got another dad who thinks you can just waltz in and buy NeeDoh.* There is a sigh, maybe two. *Who’s gonna take this? Who’s gonna explain to this person the NeeDoh madness?*

NEEDOH, Page A7



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Paul Weingard, president and CEO of Schylling, showed a Nice Cube NeeDoh.